

Innovation Wiki Proposal

Purpose

The **Innovation Wiki** will serve as the permanent, structured record of our organization's innovation efforts. It ensures that every implemented idea, once recognized through the *Pat on Back* system, is captured, organized, and made accessible for future learning and scaling.

This document outlines how the Innovation Wiki will function, how it integrates with existing processes (Challenge Board + Forum + Pat on Back), and how we will implement it sustainably.

How It Fits Into Our Workflow

1. **Challenge Board** → Employees become aware of customer pain points and strategic priorities.
 2. **Forum** → Employees discuss and refine ideas in an open, conversational space.
 3. **Pat on Back** → Contributors are recognized and rewarded for valuable ideas.
 4. **Innovation Wiki** → Implemented ideas are documented as case studies, including:
 - Problem statement.
 - Solution details.
 - Contributors (employees + customer tags).
 - Outcomes (metrics, impact).
 - Lessons learned.
 - Links to the original forum thread for full discussion history.
 5. **Public Stories** (optional) → Safe versions of select wiki entries are shared externally to boost branding, sales, and customer trust.
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Private vs Public Layers

- **Internal Wiki (Private):**
 - Full innovation history.
 - Sensitive customer insights.
 - Contributor details and implementation notes.
 - **Public Stories (Filtered):**
 - Safe, customer-facing highlights.
 - Showcases culture of innovation.
 - Acknowledges customer contributions where possible.
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Key Features of the Innovation Wiki

- **Structured Templates:** Every entry follows the same fields (problem, solution, contributors, impact, lessons).
- **Customer Tagging:** Each idea can reference the customer or client whose request inspired it.
- **Recognition Link:** Each entry includes who was recognized in the *Pat on Back* system, ensuring visibility of contributions.

- **Traceability:** Every wiki page links back to its original forum discussion, giving transparency and context.
 - **Search & Categorization:** Entries organized by category (Product, Process, Customer-Centricity, AI, etc.) for easy navigation.
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✂ Benefits

- **Knowledge Retention:** Prevents loss of ideas once employees move on.
 - **Cultural Reinforcement:** Employees see their contributions preserved as part of company history.
 - **Customer-Centricity:** Shows how customer feedback directly leads to improvements.
 - **Strategic Alignment:** Keeps innovations tied to organizational goals.
 - **Brand Strengthening:** Provides safe stories for marketing and sales.
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Example Architecture

Challenge Board → Forum (discussion) → Pat on Back (recognition) → Innovation Wiki (record) → Public Stories (branding)

Implementation Steps

1. **Choose Wiki Platform** (Confluence, Notion, MediaWiki, or existing company tool).
 2. **Design Templates** for consistent documentation.
 3. **Set Governance Model:** Appoint volunteer “wiki gardeners” to maintain quality.
 4. **Integrate With Forum:** Add links between forum threads and wiki entries.
 5. **Launch Pilot:** Start with 2–3 implemented ideas, test structure and usability.
 6. **Expand:** Roll out to all new implemented ideas after 1–2 months.
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Long-Term Vision

The Innovation Wiki becomes the **institutional memory of innovation**:

- Employees are motivated knowing their contributions live beyond recognition.
 - Customers see their voices turned into real outcomes.
 - Leadership gains a searchable archive of what worked, what didn’t, and why.
 - Over time, this becomes a competitive differentiator: few organizations can point to a living, evolving record of innovation.
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Conclusion

The Innovation Wiki is the natural extension of our Challenge Board and *Pat on Back* program. It closes the loop — moving from **problem awareness** → **idea discussion** → **recognition** → **permanent record**. It strengthens our culture, retains our knowledge, and enhances our reputation with customers.